

The main lesson from this week was to test an idea before putting it into practice. The only way to know if people want what I'm creating is by having real conversations. After all, AI interviews can only get you so far. The thing that stuck with me the most was asking about stories instead of opinions. When people are asked if they would use a product, they will usually say yes to protect feelings. If I ask them about a scenario, they will be more likely to provide insight into my product. The 80/20 rule also helped me during my interviews by making me listen, instead of searching for what I wanted to hear.

I am building a web app for beginner investors, so this lesson changed how I plan to talk to users. When I was brainstorming interview questions during the class they were all basic and opinion based. I started with questions like "Would it help being able to see your investments in one place?" and evolved it into "Tell me how you have tracked your investments in the past? What platforms did you use?".

The hardest part for me was staying quiet during the interviews. I wanted to explain how my product will work. The mock interviews showed me how often I jump in early. Talking to two totally different people was also difficult because I had to adapt to the different interview strategies. For example, interviewing a person with no investment experience was difficult because it was hard to get information that could improve my application. In the future asking more detailed questions will be more beneficial.

I used Claude this week to help refine my interview questions and practice mock interviews. I also used Claude Code to take advice from the interview and implement it into my product.